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Summer FLING

Even as the older ones stayed away, younger designers at Lakme Fashion Week delivered the goods



MASABA GUPTA, 20

She's just 20 and still in college. Masaba Gupta might have a famous mother in Neena Gupta and a legend as a father in Viv Richards, but she's not letting her lineage bog her down. It may have been her first collection as a GenNext designer, but Masaba's got a hold over her craft. The designer says her mother inspired her rooted and almost bohemian collection of dhoti pants and effortless tops.

By Jhilmil Motihar

There is a reason why Lakme put all their might behind one show that celebrated 10 years of fashion and bought together 20 fashion powerhouses. This was after all the only show, apart from the grand finale by Tarun Tahiliani, where older designers showcased. Lakme Fashion Week Spring-Summer 2010 in Mumbai was visibly devoid of big names. Not that they didn't flutter around. Sabyasachi Mukherjee announced his next venture—designing luxury villas in Alibaug. Narendra Kumar chose to walk

KALLOL DATTA, 25

If there's one thing he doesn't lack, it's a sense of humour. His breathe-easy dresses (he hates body con) this season may have looked pretty but they actually had cockroach prints shaped as flowers on them. The Kolkata-based designer is just four seasons old and is already leading the grunge pack.

the ramp for his design collaboration with Westside. And Wendell Rodericks, despite being unhappy with Lakme and IMG over choice of finale designer, was there to mentor the GenNext designers.

The runway they stayed clear of leading many a chirpy TV journalist to wonder where they'd get their daily dose of celebrity spotting. Manish Malhotra and Vikram Phadnis, both famous for their B-town pull, came to their rescue. If one had Kajol, the other Katrina Kaif. Both remained consistent even in their theme, which to no one's surprise was bridal wear. Malhotra, pretty yet predictable, stuck to his gota borders and sequins. Phadnis, unfortunately, went completely overboard. His garish embroidery, mismatched colours and careless styling couldn't be saved even by Sushmita Sen, his showstopper.

Already low on buzz, Lakme Fashion Week may have been a washout, much like the torrential downpour on the last day, had it not been for the sparkling



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